

module-10-herbs-aushadhi - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - middle band

Module 10 — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Auṣadhi* · **Band:** Middle (6-8) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

Six kitchen-and-garden healing plants.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 10's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Pass around small samples of tulsī, neem, turmeric, ginger, ajwain, mint. “*Sniff each one. Which has the sharpest smell? What’s in your kitchen? Today: six plants of Āyurveda, with traditional uses AND modern active compounds.*”

Core idea · 15 min

Six common Āyurveda herbs:

Sanskrit	Common name	Active compound	Use
Tulasī	Holy basil	Eugenol	Colds, immunity
Nimba	Neem	Azadirachtin	Skin (external)
Haridrā	Turmeric	Curcumin	Anti-inflammatory
Ārdraka	Ginger	Gingerol	Digestion, nausea
Yavānī	Ajwain	Thymol	Digestion
Pudīnā	Mint	Menthol	Coolant, freshness

Safety: kitchen amounts (cooking) are safe for most. Therapeutic doses require a qualified practitioner. Neem oil orally has documented hepatotoxicity at high doses — NEVER ingest neem oil.

Demonstration · 10 min

Two-herb deep dive. Pair students — each pair takes one herb (rotation through the 6). 5 minutes to identify: leaf, smell, active compound, one traditional use. Quick presentation.

Source moment · 5 min

Paraphrase Atharva Veda 8.7.4: “*The herbs grew before the heavens, three ages before the gods.*” (A poetic way of saying plants long predate human medicine.)

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Six-herb identification deck. Each pair builds a deck: 6 cards, each with the plant, Sanskrit name, active compound, one traditional use, one safety warning.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“Which herb surprised you most? Why?”

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — What is auṣadhi?
- **Day 02** — Tulsī — holy basil
- **Day 03** — Neem — bitter healer
- **Day 04** — Turmeric — golden root
- **Day 05** — Ginger — warming root
- **Day 06** — Ajwain — carom seed
- **Day 07** — Mint — cooling leaf
- **Day 08** — Herbs and the doṣas (link to Module 4)
- **Day 09** — Build the class herb deck
- **Day 10** — Final share + assessment

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.